The vision

Our vision is to revolutionize workplace feedback with a discreet, desk-integrated device that transforms employee engagement by encouraging interactive feedback sessions throughout the day. In a world where over a billion office workers struggle to find meaning in traditional employee surveys, participation is low, and 25% of managers find the process ineffective. This outdated system not only disturbs employees but also misses opportunities to capture insights that could improve well-being and performance, securing a healthy workplace. It's time for a smarter and more dynamic approach to workplace feedback. Our tool is mainly designed to improve engagement of surveys and receive real-time data but can easily be setup for additional features such as to provide prompts for brief physical exercises to lower the risk of musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) and connect to the preferred collaboration platform just to mention a few. Designed to be simple and intuitive, our device feels like a natural extension of any workspace while the complete solution aligns with SDG 3: *Good Health and Well-being*, SDG 8: *Decent Work and Economic Growth*, and SDG 9: *Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure*. We plan to launch in Danish companies and expand to neighboring countries, eventually reaching a global market.

The pain

In today's workplace, employee engagement with feedback remains low, with average survey response rates below 50% because employees feel that completing surveys adds to their workload without leading to meaningful change. This can create a sense of discouragement as they may believe their feedback isn't making a real difference which is not completely wrong since data show that 27% of managers never review the survey results at all. Additionally, physical health issues like MSDs and concentration problems are significant concerns, with high rates of reported work-related pain and mental burnouts among workers. These challenges emphasizes the need for more effective methods to capture the attention of the employees and gather the necessary feedback to improve the employee well-being.

The solution

COMPANIO is your office companion designed to enhance employee engagement and well-being. This intuitive, knob-based device with a visually appealing display integrates seamlessly into any workspace. It prompts beneficial breaks for recommended posture changes or brief exercises, helping refresh the mind and prevent injuries. The device redefines employee surveys by integrating them into these breaks, making feedback sharing less of a burden and more of a natural, enjoyable part of the workday. Surveys are presented with a color-coded system simplifying responses while increasing the accuracy and engagement. This approach ensures that feedback is gathered in the most pleasant way possible, avoiding the fatigue of long surveys. COMPANIO collects valuable real-time data on work patterns and employee satisfaction, offering continuous insights for management. It also has the potential for integration with collaboration software like MS Teams for enhanced functionality such as a busy indicator or meeting notifications. We will also develop an app with similar features to preempt the market and provide an accessible solution for those who are working from home or have flexible workstations.

Value Proposition

We offer a comprehensive solution through our device, which enhances holistic well-being by integrating interactive surveys with mental and physical health benefits. The device facilitates engaging, purposeful breaks and improves survey response rates and feedback quality. This approach helps reduce stress and burnout and eventually boosting productivity. Additionally, it unifies the company by making employee feedback feasible and transparent. Companies benefit from timely, accurate insights that enhance job satisfaction and employee retention, creating a more cohesive workplace and ultimately adding more value to the company.

Business model

Additional to direct sales of the device, we aim to generate value from subscription plans for ongoing support and updates as well as licensing technology to partners. Revenue would also come from premium analytics and consulting services, as well as customization and integration options. The iOS/Android application will be accessible through licenses bought by the company.

Market & competition

Our initial market focus is on Danish companies, where we target around 1 million office workers across 150,000 businesses. We project an initial Total Addressable Market (TAM) of 10,000 units in Denmark, equating to an estimated turnover of EUR 2 million. Next we aim to expand into Sweden and Norway, with expected TAMs of 15,000 and 10,000 units respectively partnering with international consultants. As we have established a solid network in the Nordics we plan to enter Germany and the UK, targeting TAMs of 50,000 and 30,000 units. Globally, the potential market includes over 1 billion office workers, providing substantial growth opportunities as we scale.

Digital surveys: Existing web-based tools often face low engagement, with response rates typically ranging from 30-60%. These tools are usually employed only a few times a year, with the most frequent being pulse surveys aimed at gathering real-time data. However, the interval between pulse surveys is rarely shorter than every other week and face additional difficulties with response rates.

To prevent MSDs: While smartphone apps already offer exercise recommendations, they are not designed for office use and are often expensive individual subscriptions. Additionally, hiring physiotherapists to promote physical activity and using adjustable tables to improve posture is very beneficial, but their effectiveness is limited if not actively utilized by employees.

How COMPANIO stands out: COMPANIO offers a unique value by combining interactive, engaging feedback mechanisms with purposeful breaks. Through the introduction of gamification, we're transforming the way feedback is provided in the office, making the process more fun and motivating employees to actively participate, which yields more consistent real-time data. This approach enhances survey response rates and overall employee well-being, distinguishing us from traditional survey tools.

Traction

We are actively working on a functional prototype with a few components already acquired and being tested. These early prototypes have allowed us to test core features and refine the product concept. As we progress, we are focusing on improving the design with the most suitable and eco-friendly materials and functionality to make a more robust version that will be showcased to potential partners and investors. We have conducted qualitative interviews with key companies, including Assa Abloy and Pascal A/S, and received positive feedback and strong interest, confirming the significant market potential for our solution.

Team

Marius Mainz Elkjær, CEO and founder: While pursuing his master's degree in Electrical Engineering, Marius leads the design and development of the device. With three years of experience as a student assistant in the R&D department of a tech company and a strong personal portfolio, he is determined to provide a high-quality solution.

Elton Bryde Amisse, CCO: Elton will be responsible for the commercial activities. With experience from his work in the B-2-B market and his Graduate Diploma in Business Administration, he has the experience to set strategic plans for increasing the level of knowledge for the product and solution.

Roadmap

With the necessary funding, we have a clear plan for the next 12 months with the end goal of a complete solution ready to be tested in initial office settings within a year.

Budget

	Q4 - 2024	Q1 - 2025	Q2 - 2025	Q3 - 2025
Product Development activities	• Initial prototype design • Material procurement • Firmware planning	• Prototype development • Initial firmware development • Testing setup • App develop-ment	• Firmware testing • Software acquisition • Prototype refinement	• Extended testing • Final adjustments • Documentation • Tech BBQ presentation
Business Development activities	• Initial market research • Identifying potential partners • Strategic planning	• Market research • Initial partner engagement • Strategy development • Establish a competent team	• Networking • Business development • Finding suitable production partners • Patent application initialization	• Continued business development • Partnership securing • Scaling preparation
Budget	• Components, materials and CNC machinery for prototypes ≈ 10.000 DKK • Development costs ≈ 8.000 DKK • Material samples for casing ≈ 2.000 DKK	• Production of ≈100 units for testing ≈ 35.000DKK • Firmware development ≈ 10.000DKK • Testing expenses ≈ 5.000DKK • Consultant fees ≈ 15.000DKK	• Extended firmware testing ≈5.000DKK • Database expenses 1.000DKK • Prototype refinement ≈4.000DKK	• Final prototype adjustments • Documentation • Conference and networking expenses
	15.000 DKK	65.000 DKK	10.000 DKK	10.000 DKK
			Total amount applied for	**100.000 DKK**

Figure 1: Budget and road map for future work.